Bow Valley College

# Course Outline

## ELLA0108

ELL Academic 8
Winter 2022 - Winter 2022

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# ELLA0108 ELL Academic 8

## COURSE DESCRIPTION

The Full-time Academic Program teaches language, settlement, and employment skills in the context of themes relevant to learners. This 15-week course aligns with the Canadian Language Benchmarks (CLBs) and focuses on reading, writing, listening, speaking. Academic 8 is part of Stage Two of the CLBs and corresponds to intermediate English proficiency. In this stage, learners practice skills required for more in-depth participation in a greater variety of situations. Learners in Stage Two can function in most familiar social, educational, and workplace situations, as well as some less predictable contexts. Learners exit the course with a CLB8. Instruction is learner-centered, task-based, and stresses community, education, and work-related language tasks. The program follows Portfolio-Based Language Assessment (PBLA) practices, focusing on what learners can do in English. Learners' progress is assessed by performance on a series of real-world tasks completed throughout the term and collected in their portfolio.

| | |
|---|---|
| REQUISITES | None |
| EQUIVALENTS | None |
| CREDITS | 16 |
| HOURS | 400 |
| ELIGIBLE FOR PLAR | No |

## COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Bow Valley College is committed to ensuring our graduates can demonstrate their abilities in key areas that will make them effective citizens and encourage their development as lifelong learners. In addition to the discipline-specific skills that learners acquire in their programs, the College has identified ten learning outcomes.

**College-Wide Outcomes:**

1. Communication
2. Thinking Skills
3. Numeracy and Financial Literacy
4. Working with Others
5. Digital Literacy
6. Positive Attitudes and Behaviours
7. Continuous Learning
8. Health and Wellness Awareness
9. Citizenship and Intercultural Competence
10. Environmental Sustainability

| # | COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S) | COLLEGE WIDE OUTCOMES SUPPORTED |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Facilitate effective communication in a variety of real-world settings | 1-10 |
| 2 | Improve intelligibility (pronunciation, intonation, stress) | 1-10 |
| 3 | Increase comprehensibility (word choice, sentence structure, grammar) | 1-10 |
| 4 | Model intercultural competence in community and workplace contexts | 1, 2, 3, 4, 6 |
| 5 | Promote community orientation and engagement | 9 |
| 6 | Enrich learning with effective use of technology | 5 |
| 7 | Provide pathways to employment, workplace training, foundational learning, or academic English programs | 4, 7 |

## COURSE MODULES AND SCHEDULE

**Course schedule subject to change, depending on delivery mode and term of study. For exact dates, please consult the Course Offering Information in Brightspace.*

| WEEK/HOURS | MODULES |
|---|---|
| 0-400 Hours* | *The following is just an outline of the possible topics covered in the course and a rough estimate of the time range that would be associated for a learner to learn that topic. Learners may not have to complete all topics listed. Topics selected at the discretion of the instructor based on learner needs assessment. |
| 0-100 Hours | Listening: • Understand moderately complex social exchanges (such as expressions of and responses to gratitude, hopes, appreciation, complaints, disappointment, satisfaction, dissatisfaction, approval, disapproval, formal welcomes and farewells, condolences and congratulations). • Understand extended multistep directions or instructions for technical or non-technical tasks • Understand communication intended to influence or persuade (such as extended warnings, threats, suggestions, recommendations and proposed solutions) in situations related to personal decisions or to work-related issues in own field. • Understand group interactions about abstract and complex ideas on familiar topics. • Understand extended monologues or presentations on topics that are generally familiar and related to general knowledge or technical/work-related issues in own field. |

| | |
|---|---|
| 0-100 Hours | Speaking: • Participate in less routine social conversations for most everyday purposes (such as expressing and responding to empathy, clarifying conflicts, and providing reassurance). • Participate in brief professional phone calls • Give instructions and directions for a broad range of technical and non-technical tasks, procedures and processes. • Propose or recommend solutions to problems in a familiar area. • Give detailed information; express and qualify opinions or concerns; present solutions and options; indicate opposition or support for a stand in one-on-one interactions and small group discussions or meetings. • Give presentations to describe and explain structures, systems or processes based on research. [Presentations are up to about 20 minutes long; topics are familiar, concrete, or abstract.] |
| 0-100 Hours | Reading: • Understand moderately complex social messages (such as those conveying general opinions, assessments of current events or situations, and responses to complaints or sympathy). • Understand extended, moderately complex, multistep instructions and instructional texts for established (set) procedures related to specialized tasks. [Instructions are about 10 to 13 steps in a clear and explicit text of about 8 to 15 paragraphs, not always presented step by step.] • Locate, integrate and use 3 or 4 pieces of information from moderately complex formatted texts. • Get information from moderately complex business/service texts containing proposals, recommendations and statements of rules, regulations or policies. • Understand moderately complex extended descriptions, feature articles, reports and narrations. • Interpret information contained in moderately complex formatted texts (such as tables, graphs, diagrams and website navigation menus). • Access, locate and integrate several pieces of information from relevant online reference sources. |
| 0-100 Hours | Writing: • Convey personal messages in formal and informal correspondence for an expanded range of social purposes (such as expressing and responding to sympathy, clarifying a conflict, or giving reassurance). [Message is about 3 paragraphs, for a familiar audience, often requiring diplomacy, tact and some precision.] • Reduce oral discourse about established procedures (given in a live demonstration, over the phone, or from pre-recorded audio or video material) into notes that can be used to write instructions. [Oral discourse is up to about 20 minutes.] • Reduce a text of up to about 2 pages to an outline or summary. [Topic is of personal relevance and may be related to a specialized field.] • Write business or service correspondence for an expanding range of purposes (such as giving information in memoranda, documenting work done, indicating a problem, requesting a change, or requesting information). [Writing is up to about 3 paragraphs.] • Complete an expanded range of forms, including extended application forms and workplace forms with pre-set formats. [Forms have over 40 items; text responses on forms are up to 1 paragraph.] • Write 3 or 4 connected paragraphs to relate a historical event, provide a detailed description of a phenomenon, explain a procedure, or express and analyze opinions on a familiar abstract topic. • Write a paragraph to explain information in a table, graph, flow chart or diagram. |

## ASSESSMENT

| COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S) | ASSESSMENT | WEIGHT |
|---|---|---|
| 1-7 | Portfolio-Based Language Assessment (PBLA) is utilized to assess and evaluate learners' progress in language learning. PBLA facilitates assessment for learning by documenting students' language learning over time, highlighting strengths and challenges, and providing frequent opportunities for feedback, reflection, self-assessment, and revision. A combination of formative and summative assessment is used to monitor learner progress against course outcomes. Testing occurs throughout the term. Instructor observations, anecdotal notes, marked work, portfolio assessment and summative testing all factor into the CLBs assigned at term end. | P/BD/F |

Important: For details on each assignment and exam, please see the Course Offering Information.

## PERFORMANCE STANDARDS

A grade of P is required to pass this course. Learners may be required to pass this course in order to progress in the program or to meet specific program completion requirements.

Completion of course work and adherence to attendance policy determine final grade.

Please consult with the program area or the Bow Valley College website for further details.

## GRADING SCHEME

| **Symbol** | **Description** | **Value in GPA** |
|---|---|---|
| P | Pass | N/A |
| F | Fail | N/A |
| BD | Basic/Developing (Foundational programming courses only) | N/A |

## REQUIRED LEARNING RESOURCES

All learning materials will be provided by the instructor.

Additional learning resources may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

## ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

The Full-time Academic Program is funded by Immigration, Refugees and Citizenship Canada (IRCC) as part of the Language Instruction for Newcomers to Canada (LINC) program. LINC is integral to IRCC's mandates of immigrant settlement and employability. The focus of the LINC program is providing the communicative and intercultural competence immigrants need to successfully integrate into Canadian society and secure employment.

The Canadian Language Benchmarks (CLBs) include four strands, listening, speaking, reading, and writing. To go up a CLB in a strand, learners must successfully complete most of the criteria on the assessed tasks in that strand. To progress to the next level, your CLBs must go up in at least three strands. For example, if your CLBs go up in three or four strands, you may be eligible to progress to the next level. However, if your CLBs go up in two or fewer strands, you will continue in the same level next term.

Additional information may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

## ACADEMIC ACCOMMODATIONS

Learners with a disability (learning, physical, and/or mental health) may qualify for academic and exam accommodations. For more information, or to apply for accommodations, learners should make an appointment with Accessibility Services in the Learner Success Services (LSS) Department. Accessibility Services can also assist learners who may be struggling with learning but do not have a formal diagnosis. To make an appointment visit LSS on the first floor of the south campus or call 403-410-1440. It is the learner's responsibility to contact Accessibility Services and request academic accommodations. For more information, please visit our website at http://www.bowvalleycollege.ca/accessibility.

## INSTITUTIONAL POLICIES

Bow Valley College is committed to the highest standards of academic integrity and honesty. Learners are urged to become familiar with and uphold the following policies: Academic Honesty (500-1-7), Learner Code of Conduct, Procedures and Guidelines (500-1-1), Learner Appeals (500-1-12), Attendance (500-1-10), Grading (500-1-6), Academic Continuance and Graduation (500-1-5), and Electronic Communications (300-2-13). Audio or video recording of lectures, labs, seminars, or any other teaching and learning environment by learners is allowed only with consent of the instructor as part of an approved accommodation plan.

Recorded material is to be used solely for personal study and is not being used or distributed without prior written consent from the instructor.

**Turnitin:**

Students may be required to submit their course work to Turnitin, a third-party service provider engaged by BVC. Turnitin identifies plagiarism by checking databases of electronic books and articles, archived webpages, and previously submitted student papers. Students acknowledge that any course work or essays submitted to Turnitin will be included as source documents in the Turnitin.com reference database, where it will be used solely to detect plagiarism. The terms that apply to a student's use of Turnitin are described on Turnitin.com.

**Online Exam Proctoring:**

Examinations for this course may require proctoring through an online proctoring service. Online proctoring enables online exam taking within a controlled and monitored environment, thereby enhancing academic integrity. Online proctoring may occur through a variety of methods, including but not limited to:

a. live online proctoring where a remote invigilator authenticates identity and observes completion of an exam using specialized software and recordings;
b. automated proctoring where the exam session is recorded and AI (artificial intelligence) analyzed;
c. browser lockdown that limits access to other applications, websites, copying, printing, screen capture and other functions; or
d. a combination of both live/automated proctoring and browser lockdown.

Course instructors will review recordings, analyses, and data obtained through online proctoring for academic integrity infractions. It is the student's responsibility to meet the technical, software, location, and identity verification requirements necessary to enable online proctoring.

Further details of these policies are available in the Academic Calendar and on the Bow Valley College website, bowvalleycollege.ca.

Learners are encouraged to keep a copy of this course outline for future reference.

**Collection of Personal Information:**

This course, including your image and voice, may be recorded and made available to you and other students taking the course section. By attending the class(es) online or in person, you consent to the collection of your personal information. If you do not wish to be recorded, please contact your instructor before starting the course/class to discuss alternative arrangements.

You may use the recordings only for educational purposes and you must not copy, share, or use the recordings for any other purpose without the instructor's express permission.

Your personal information is collected in accordance with section 33(c) of the Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act (Alberta) to deliver academic programming, support learner flexibility, promote universal design for learning principles, and for purposes consistent with the course activities and outcomes.

If you have any questions about the collection, disclosure, use, or protection of this information, please contact the College's Access and Privacy Officer at foip@bowvalleycollege.ca.